Supporting Information for "Gap position, not gap length, governs the error of annual thermal extremes in incomplete river-temperature records"

AUTHOR ONE[1]

[1]AFFILIATION PENDING AUTHOR CONFIRMATION

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Introduction

This supporting information records what belongs to the record rather than to the argument: data provenance, protocol history, the predictions declared for this round that were not met, the runs that were discarded and why, and the reproduction path. Nothing here is required to follow the article.

S1 Data sources

Daily water-temperature series were assembled from nine public providers (Table S1); two further agencies (SMHI, UK Environment Agency) supply the never-developed transport panel. Each provider's product, documented statistic, quality codes, licence and acquisition route were re-verified against the provider's own documentation on 2026-10-12 (`results/wrr_submission_ready/measurement_provenance_dictionary.csv`). Eight of the eleven publish under a named open licence and none required a data-use agreement, but LUBW reserves copyright on its raw values: those seven networks are not redistributed here and are read locally through LUBW's own service.

Station coordinates were assembled for all 457 stations: from the providers' own catalogues already held in the repository for FOEN, CHMI, SYKE, LUBW, GKD Bayern, NVE and Rijkswaterstaat and for nine USGS gauges; from the USGS

Table S1. Providers and their role in the study.

provider	country	role
ARSO	Slovenia	development and reserved
CHMI	Czechia	development and reserved
FOEN	Switzerland	development
GKD Bayern	Germany (Bavaria)	development and reserved
LUBW	Germany (Baden-Württemberg)	development and reserved
NVE	Norway	development and reserved
Rijkswaterstaat	Netherlands	development
SYKE	Finland	development
USGS	United States	development and reserved

NWIS site service for the remaining 195 United States gauges; and from ARSO's public station feed for all 47 Slovenian stations. Every row of the coordinate table in the repository records its source.

Daily 2 m air temperature is NASA POWER (MERRA-2), 1 January 1981 to 31 August 2026, one point per station at the product's native resolution: 16,679 days for each of the 457 stations. An earlier version of this study used a much smaller forcing table covering 2.3% of development cases; both are retained and Section 4.4.2 of the article compares them.

Basin characteristics for the United States subset are GAGES-II, joined on the eight-digit gauge identifier and matching 140 of 204 eligible stations.

S2 Quality control and the definition of a network

A *network* is a provider's group of stations on a common river system, which is the unit at which donor stations are available to one another. Networks are the clustering unit for every interval in the article, because station-years within a network share weather, regulation and instrumentation.

Waterbody class was assigned per network from the provider's own naming and an explicit map; seas, lakes, canals, estuaries and deltas are listed and excluded

rather than averaged into a river result. Reference series are never imputed: a calendar year with any missing day contributes no truth. Stations with fewer than four fully observed calendar years are excluded, because the leave-one-year-out estimator protocol requires them. The resulting denominator, with every exclusion and its count, is in the repository. The same stations contribute 2422 station-years with at least 360 daily slots and at least one missing day; those form the deployment panel of Section 4.4.3 of the article.

Three measurement strata are reported rather than merged. In the study panel, five providers document a daily mean that the parser reads directly (USGS, FOEN, GKD Bayern, NVE, LUBW); two are project-derived daily means of the provider's own sub-daily values (CHMI's T_O instantaneous series, Rijkswaterstaat's raw `N V T` readings); and two are not a documented daily mean at all (SYKE's 08:00 nearshore reference reading, ARSO's undocumented statistic). The transport panel adds the UK Environment Agency, which documents a daily mean, and SMHI and Hub'Eau, whose daily statistics are undocumented and continuous respectively; those sit in the assurance strata recorded by the transport seal. Restricting the development panel to the documented-daily-mean stratum gives a contrast of -5.7 points ($[-6.5, -4.9]$, 84 networks) against -6.4 for the full panel, and the reserved panel -6.6 ($[-7.9, -5.3]$, 29 networks) against -7.1; the sealed confirmation is USGS-only and lies entirely inside the documented stratum (`amendments/provider_contract_sensitivity/`). Each provider's product, documented statistic, quality codes, licence and acquisition route are tabulated with verbatim evidence in `measurement_provenance_dictionary.csv` and `current_data_acquisition.csv`.

Transport-panel panels receive one additional structural quality-control pass before sealing, applied identically to every provider and recorded before any score: warm-season (May–September) runs of three or more consecutive days at exactly 0.0 °C are blanked as stuck-sensor values. Two such runs were found in the UK Environment Agency ingest, one of them inside a hottest-30 window; the rule and its counts are in `multi_agency_ingest/QC_SUMMARY.json` and the per-provider copies in `multi_agency_ingest/uk_ea/qc_report.csv` and `multi_agency_ingest/smhi/qc_report.csv`.

S3 Protocol history

The study was pre-registered before the reserved networks were opened on 2026-09-23. Three aspects of that freeze were incomplete or wrong and are recorded here rather than silently repaired.

The incumbent's imputed limit was mis-stated. An earlier version placed the comparison at a thirteen-week (91-day) limit attributed to Johnson et al. (2021). The source says twenty weeks. The analysis code now uses 140 days and every artifact that used the old value was re-run; Section 4.4.1 of the article reports the corrected operating point. The direction of the error flattered the incumbent at that point, so correcting it reduces the screen's advantage there from 6.2 to 4.4 percentage points.

The weighting between outage arms was not declared. The case set mixes an empirical arm, drawn from the outage geometry the same networks experience, with a stratified arm built to span the decision space. Their base rates differ by an order of magnitude. The pre-registered test was run on the pooled set, as declared; Section 4.2.3 reports the decomposition and states that the declared effect is not met on the empirical arm alone.

The natural scale of the peak has two values. Computed over the full eligible roster it is 1.06 °C; recomputed inside the development case table it is 1.08 °C. The primary tolerance is 0.50 °C throughout except in cross-metric comparisons, where each endpoint's scale is recomputed on the same footing. The tolerance sweep shows the axis ordering is unchanged between 0.25 and 1.0 standard deviations.

S4 Confirmation, transport and the amendment register

The sealed confirmation. Thirty-nine USGS HUC4 networks outside the v17/v18 development panel (91 stations, 18 HUC2 contexts, 8973 designed outage cases) were ingested, hashed and scored once with the frozen certificate at the pre-registered operating point. The pooled contrast is -7.9 points ($[-10.2, -5.8]$) and the empirical arm -1.7 ($[-3.0, -0.7]$). The panel is outside the development programme but is not untouched by the wider programme: a repo-wide, provider-aware audit of every artifact carrying a station identifier finds 24 of the 39 networks in earlier programme iterations, so the earlier "never used" label was wrong and is cor-

rected in `AMENDMENT_prior_access_sealed_panel.md`. The result does not rest on the touched networks: on the 15 networks with no outcome-bearing prior use the pooled contrast is -9.4 points ($[-12.4, -6.0]$) with an empirical-arm gain of -3.7 ($[-5.8, -1.6]$), and on the 45 outcome-clean stations it is -8.3 ($[-10.4, -6.4]$). Those subsets are read from the already-sealed score and are a transparency diagnostic, not new confirmation.

The transport test. The confirmation is single-agency, so the pre-registered transport protocol (`MULTI_AGENCY_TRANSPORT_PROTOCOL.md`) recruits agencies absent from the v17 roster and scores the same frozen configuration once on them. Three amendments were recorded before sealing: prior access is judged per station against every artifact in the repository (metadata catalogues keyed by `site_id` carry no series values and are not series use), providers whose published values are labelled uncontrolled form a separate assurance stratum reported alongside the pooled verdict, and networks from a provider that took part in development may enter only as a labelled secondary stratum. The protocol fixes the primary endpoint, tolerance, retention, the pooled decision rule ($\Delta \leq -1.0$ percentage points with a clustered interval excluding zero and at least two providers in the same direction) and the requirement that the pooled and quality-checked-only verdicts agree. It also discloses that it was designed after the USGS score was known, so it is a transport test and never a pristine first confirmation.

The sealed transport panel holds 53 networks: 32 primary networks from Sweden (SMHI, 16), England (UK Environment Agency, 2) and France (Hub'Eau, 14) across three climate contexts and four assurance strata combinations, plus 21 Norwegian (NVE) basins as the secondary stratum. All 291 candidate stations are unused anywhere in the repository, the 47 Hub'Eau and 143 SMHI stations sit in the provider-published-unqualified stratum, and one structural quality-control pass (June–September runs of three or more days at exactly 0.0 °C blanked as stuck sensors) was applied identically to every provider before the seal. The primary panel is 17 826 cases: pooled contrast -4.6 points ($[-6.5, -3.3]$), with SMHI -4.3, Hub'Eau -4.9 and the UK EA -6.4 (2 networks, wide interval); the quality-checked stratum alone is -6.2 ($[-8.4, -4.5]$) and the empirical arm -1.9 ($[-3.3, -1.0]$). The pre-declared rule is met on both the pooled primary panel and the quality-checked stratum, and

the two agree. The secondary NVE stratum is -6.1 ($[-8.7, -4.6]$) and the extended pooled estimate -5.2 ($[-6.7, -4.1]$).

The amendment register. Each adversarial finding closed after the freeze has an amendment directory holding the recomputation, the preserved pre-fix bytes and a report: instrument error under a locked method (`step22_noise_post_fix`), support-width uncertainty and the fixed-centre dilation test (`e6_support_width_uncertainty`), exact-donor-count mechanism control (`step5_mechanism_equal_k`), the climatological-peak proxy's misclassification rate (`peak_proxy_bridge`), provider-contract sensitivity (`provider_contract_sensitivity`), a faithful reimplementation of the cited air-regression baseline (`faithful_baseline`), hidden-bias sensitivity (`mnar_pattern_mixture`), cold-season support axes (`winter_regulatory`), and the sealed panel's prior-access diagnostic (`sealed_usgs_prior_access_diagnostic`). The maintenance counterfactual was recomputed under multi-year outage placement (`e1_maintenance_recompute`) and remains exploratory.

S5 Predictions that failed

Three predictions were written down before the analyses that tested them and were not met. All three are in the article; they are gathered here because a reader looking for them should not have to hunt.

1. *The support-restricted advantage will decay monotonically in the support width.* It does not: it is a hump peaking at a 60-day support.
2. *The estimand's own support is the best conditioning set at every support width.* It is not: below 30 days a fixed 30-day window beats it.
3. *For the sine-fit phase, two hand-chosen transition windows will beat both peak-window overlap and outage length.* They beat peak overlap decisively and tie outage length.

Failures 1 and 2 have one cause, which we then measured: the support's location is itself uncertain, so the conditioning set has to be the support dilated by that uncertainty. Failure 3 has a related cause: a hand-drawn window is a crude approximation to an influence function that is spread over half the year.

Three further numbers changed under a corrected comparison rather than under new data, and the corrected values are the ones reported. The instrument-error check had evaluated its two arms with two different reconstruction choices; with one method on both arms the perturbation moves the reserved contrast from 6.21 to 6.22 points instead of from 7.06 to 6.67, and the apparent reduction disappears. The donor-count control had not actually held the donor count fixed (the paired cases differ by up to seven donors in a third of cases); an exact-match recomputation gives +0.084 °C (0.064 to 0.110), so the claim survives and the interval is restated. The support-width crossover is an interval, not a day: the bootstrap gives 77 to 107 days and the curve is a hump peaking near 60 days, not a monotone decay.

A fourth statement was *withdrawn* rather than falsified. An earlier version framed the standing guidance as getting an ordering backwards. On the guidance's own estimands it does not; Section 4.2.2 of the article reports that a completeness threshold is the correct axis for the sine-fit mean and within 0.02 AUC of the best for the phase.

S6 Runs that were discarded

Two defects made specific artifacts unusable and both were repaired before the reserved panel was opened: outage realizations were seeded from a process-salted hash, so the case table could not be regenerated, and worker results were concatenated in completion order, so the row order was not reproducible even though the content was. A third defect affected the calibration rather than the data: an additive, per-estimator conformal scheme under-covered, because selecting the smallest of several bounds is a winner's curse that per-estimator calibration cannot see. In all three cases the affected numbers were discarded rather than reported alongside the repaired ones, and the pipeline was re-run in full.

S7 Verification and reproduction

- The case table is byte-reproducible including row order, pinned by a test.
- The extended endpoint table regenerates the same 51,524 realizations from the same deterministic seeds, which is how its rows line up with the main case table; a test checks the alignment.

- No feature may read a day the outage hides; enforced in the feature constructor and pinned by a test.
- Every table cell and audited inline number in the article is re-derived from the artifacts by an audit script that the test suite runs.
- The schematic figures are generated from editable draw.io sources held in the repository; a test checks that each exported PDF is newer than its source.
- The claim registry binds every number allowed into the abstract, key points and conclusions to an artifact and is checked by `scripts/254_wrr_claim_binding_check.py`, which recomputes the allowed numbers and flags any barred number that appears in those regions.
- Every input the current study reads is listed with a byte count and a SHA-256 in `current_data_manifest.csv` (146 networks, 0 missing), and every ingest for the transport panel records its own hashes before the seal is written.
- Failed worker runs cannot leave a success table behind: the mechanism recomputation writes its summary last inside a hash-bound generation directory and re-verifies the generation on read.

Figure S1 lays the study out as a chain and labels each link with the research question that establishes it, including the two links that earlier versions of this work left open and this one closes.

S8 Supporting figures

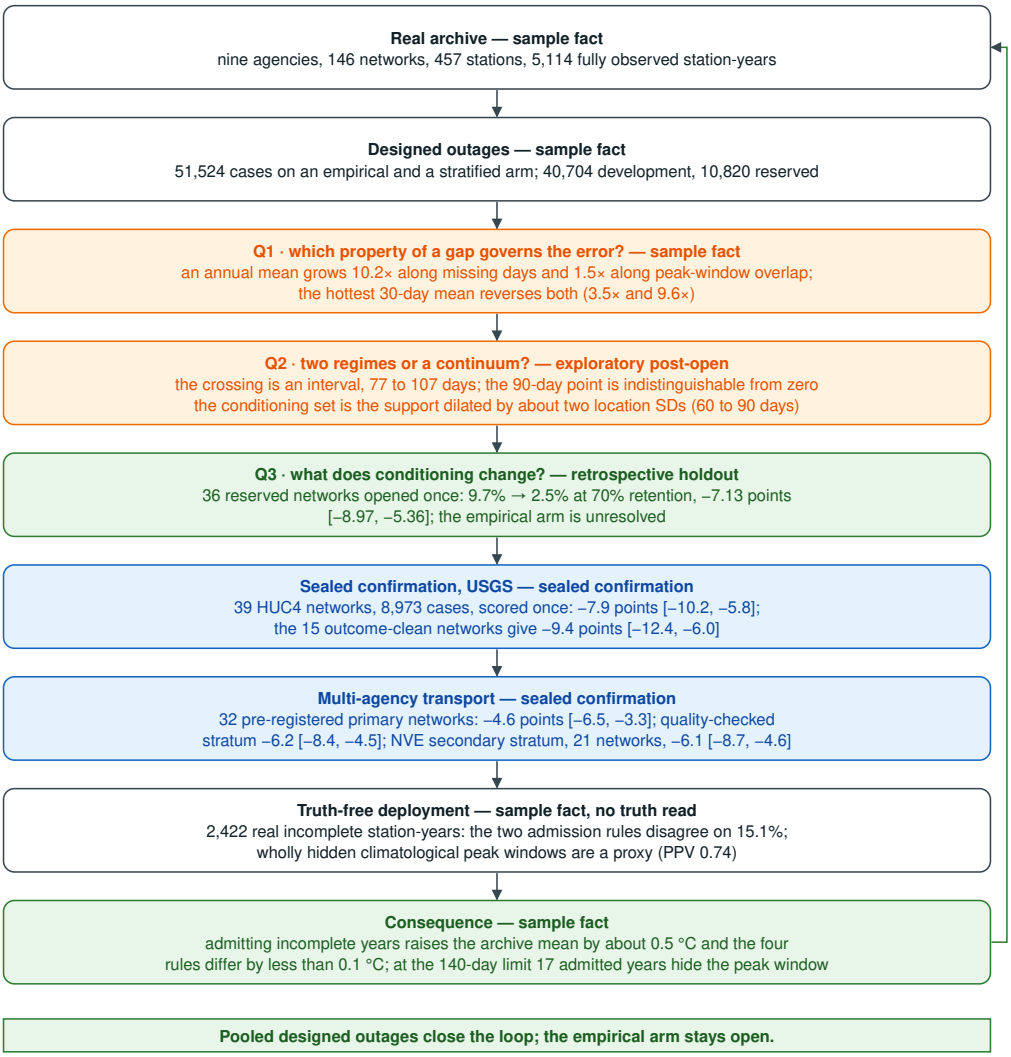


Figure S1. The evidence chain by research question. Every link is labelled with the section that establishes it and with the evidence class it rests on (sample fact, retrospective holdout, sealed confirmation, exploratory post-open); the deployment link is closed for pooled designed outages and remains open on the empirical arm, and the consequence link carries the finding that the regional aggregate barely moves.

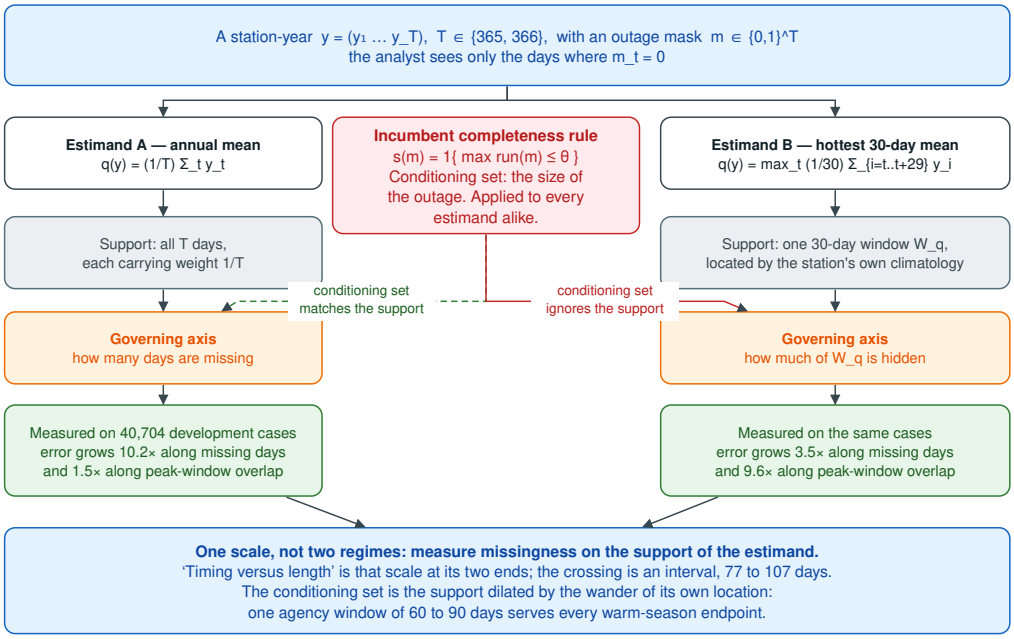


Figure S2. Problem frame (schematic), the earlier opening figure. The same station-year and outage mask feed an annual mean and a hottest 30-day mean; different supports imply different governing axes. Boxes that quote numerical gradients are mechanism diagnostics from the scored panel, not the sealed confirmation. The data-driven version of this idea is Figure 1 of the article.

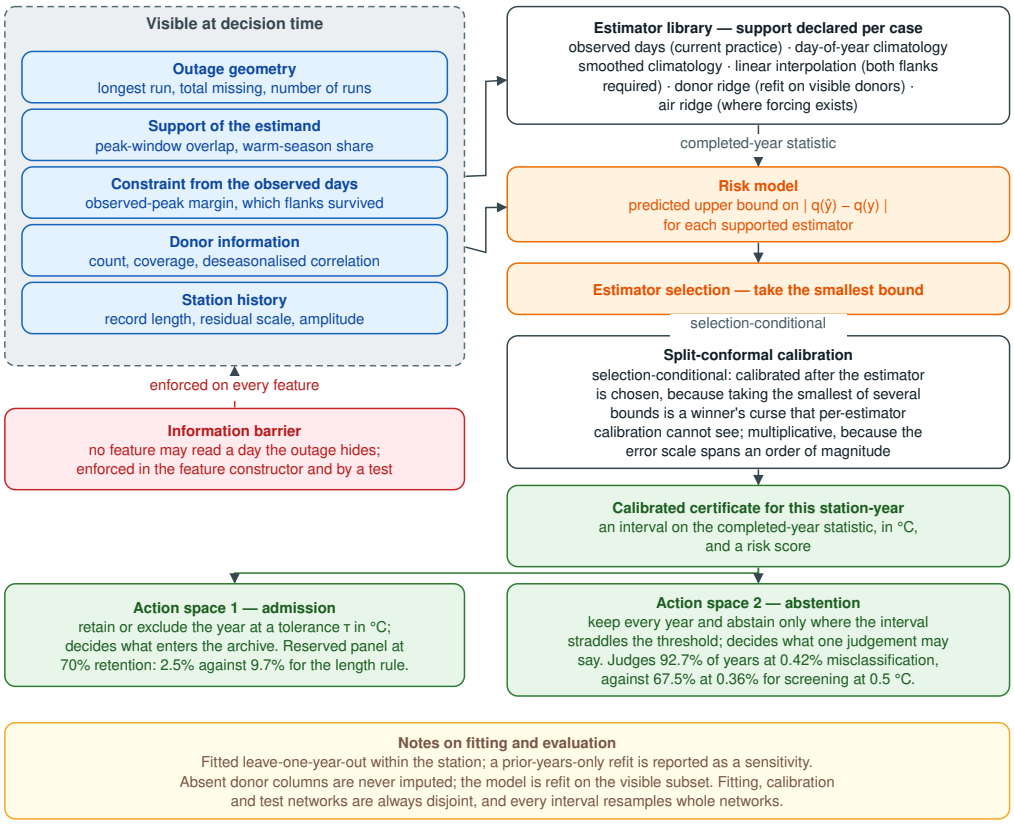


Figure S3. The screening system in detail. Left: the features visible at decision time, under an information barrier that forbids any feature from reading a day the gap hides. Centre: the estimator library with per-case support, the risk model, estimator selection, and the selection-conditional multiplicative conformal calibration. Bottom: the two action spaces the same calibrated object supports.

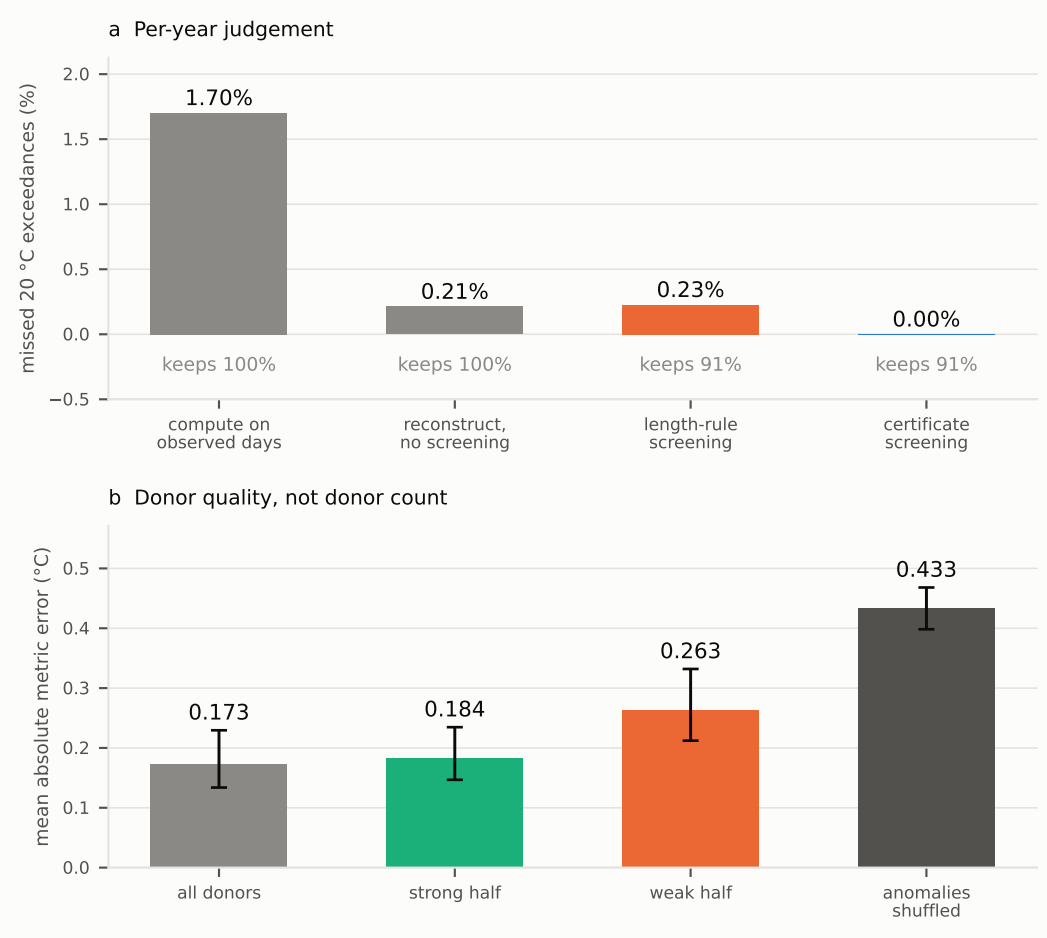


Figure S4. Multi-year trend error (a) and the donor controls (b). The panel averages eleven complete years per station, which is too short to resolve a decadal trend; the slope error is reported as a diagnostic of the reconstruction rather than as a trend estimate.

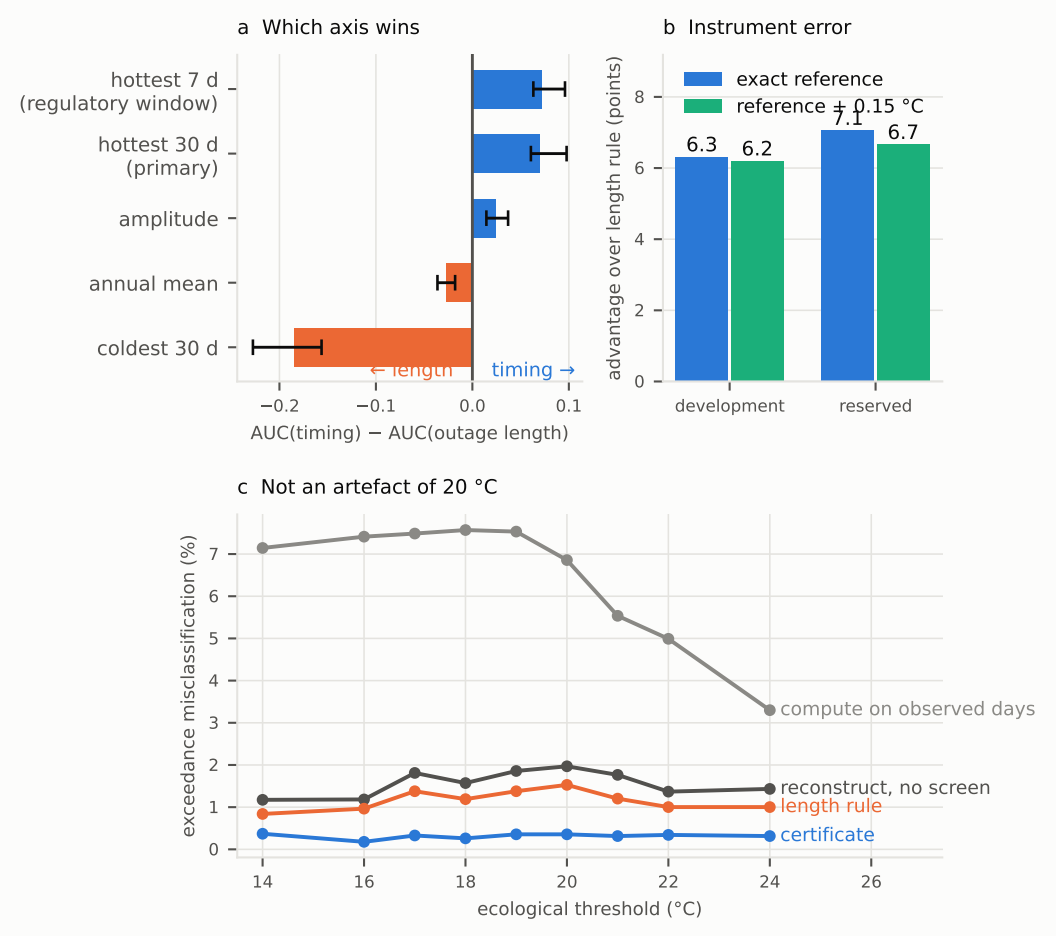


Figure S5. Development cases (n = 40 704, 110 networks; all intervals network-clustered 95%): AUC difference between the timing axis and the outage-length rule for each endpoint, in AUC units (a); the consequential-error advantage over the length rule in percentage points under a clean and a perturbed reference series, with the paired change interval (b); and the misclassification rate against the exceedance threshold in °C, per treatment (c). Panel (b) uses one reconstruction choice on both arms.

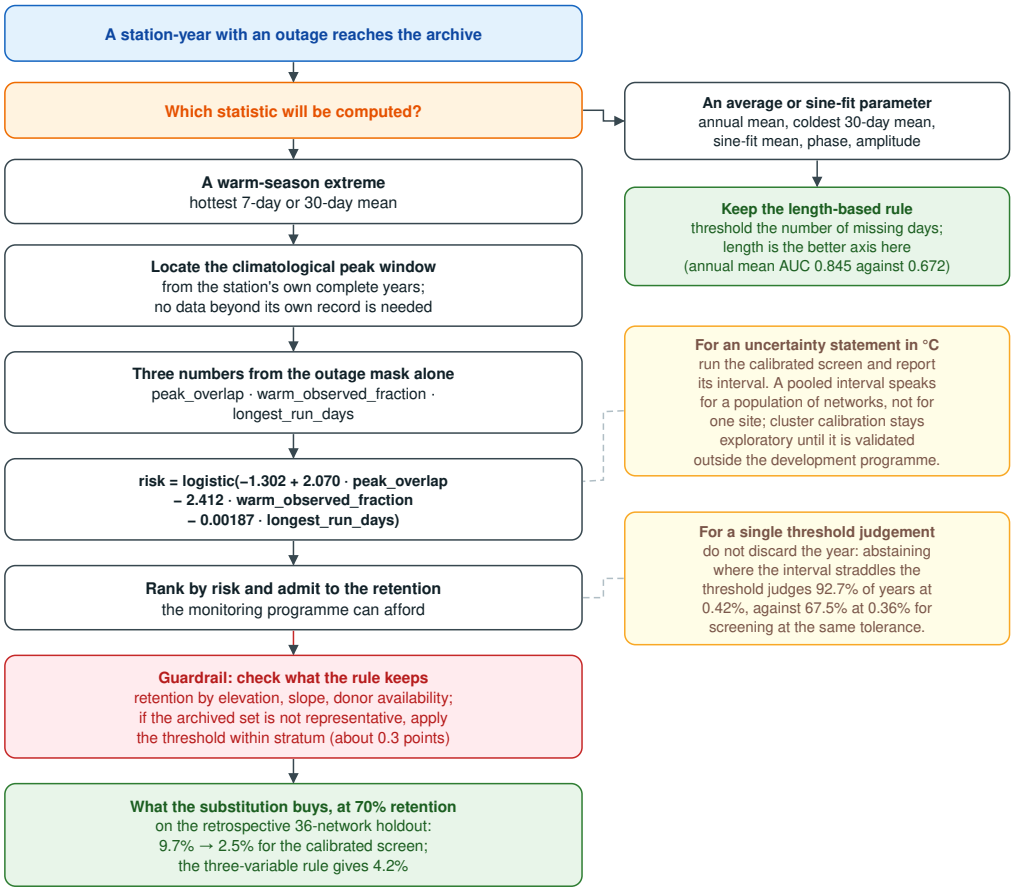


Figure S6. What an agency does with the result: which endpoint, where the peak window comes from, the three numbers of the deployable rule, the representativeness guardrail, and what the substitution buys on networks never used for fitting.

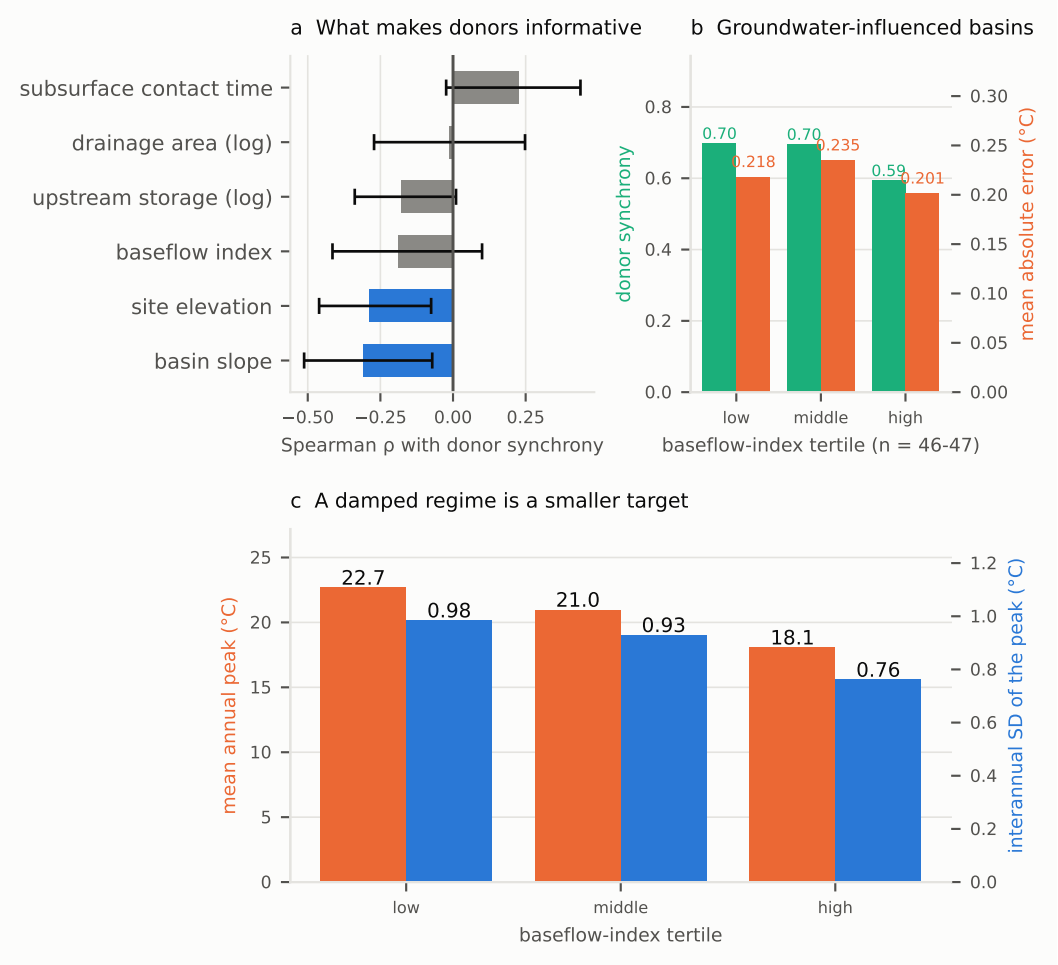


Figure S7. Catchment attribution on the United States subset, moved here from the article: 140 of 204 stations matched to GAGES-II across 57 networks. Donor synchrony against site elevation (a), completed-year absolute error (°C) against elevation (b), and the decomposition of the baseflow-index effect (c). Points are stations; bands are network-clustered 95% intervals. These are attribute associations on one country and are not a geology law.